

Word family: **notebook / notebooks**

Base word: notebook

Plural: notebooks

Useful extensions: notebook computer, laptop notebook, notebook paper, spiral notebook

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, drawing imaginary cities, or folding paper rockets out of old **notebooks**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **notebook** means:

> **a small book containing blank or lined pages used for writing, drawing, notes, or schoolwork**

Leo is reusing pages from old notebooks to fold paper rockets.

繁體中文： ** **筆記本；由多頁紙裝訂而成，用來寫字、做筆記、畫圖或做功課的小冊子

**中文翻譯： **

> “He can spend hours ... folding paper rockets out of old notebooks.”

「他可以花幾個小時.....用舊**筆記本**的紙摺紙火箭。」

Here:

old notebooks = 用過的舊筆記本 / 筆記簿

1. **notebook = book for writing notes (筆記本) — 筆記簿；記事本**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He can spend hours ... folding paper rockets out of old **notebooks**.”

「他可以花幾個小時.....用舊**筆記本**的紙摺紙火箭。」

Practice 2

> “She wrote the idea in her **notebook**.”

「她把那個想法寫在**筆記本**裡。」

Practice 3

> “I always carry a small **notebook** with me.”

「我總會隨身帶一本小**記事本**。」

notebook = 由多頁紙裝訂而成，用來寫字、記錄資料、畫圖或做筆記的小冊子

2. **school notebook** (學生筆記簿) — 課堂筆記簿；練習簿

A very common contextual use.

Practice 4

> “The students opened their **notebooks**.”

「學生打開自己的**筆記簿**。」

Practice 5

> “He copied the new vocabulary into his **notebook**.”

「他把新詞彙抄進**筆記簿**裡。」

notebook = 學生在課堂上用來抄寫、做練習或記錄學習內容的簿冊

This is still the same core physical-book sense.

3. **notebook** = personal record book (記事本) — 隨身記事本；記錄簿

Practice 6

> “The reporter took out a **notebook**.”

「記者拿出一本**記事本**。」

Practice 7

> “She keeps a **notebook** of ideas beside her bed.”

「她在床邊放一本用來記錄想法的**記事本**。」

notebook = 用來隨時記錄想法、觀察、資料或提醒事項的小型筆記簿

Again, this is not a separate lexical meaning, but a useful functional branch.

4. **notebook** = sketch/drawing notebook (畫簿) — 畫簿 ; 速寫簿

Practice 8

> “Leo filled his **notebook** with drawings.”

「Leo 在**筆記簿 / 畫簿**裡畫滿了圖。」

Practice 9

> “She carries a **notebook** for quick sketches.”

「她隨身帶一本**速寫簿**來畫草圖。」

notebook = 可用來畫圖、速寫或記錄視覺想法的簿冊

The English word does not change; Chinese depends on use.

5. **notebook computer** (手提電腦) — 筆記型電腦 ; 手提電腦

This is the main genuinely separate modern meaning.

Practice 10

> “She bought a new **notebook computer**.”

「她買了一部新的**手提電腦 / 筆記型電腦**。」

Practice 11

> “The company issued lightweight **notebooks** to staff.”

「公司向員工派發輕便的**筆記型電腦**。」

****notebook = 一種輕便、可攜式的個人電腦；即 notebook computer****

This use is especially common in technical/product language.

In everyday English today, ****laptop**** is often more common.

6. ****notebook = laptop computer (科技產品) — 手提電腦****

The shortened product use.

Practice 12

> “This ****notebook**** weighs less than two kilograms.”

「這部****手提電腦****重量不足兩公斤。」

Practice 13

> “The new ****notebook**** has a longer battery life.”

「這款新****筆記型電腦****的電池續航時間更長。」

****notebook = notebook computer 的簡稱，指較輕薄、可攜式電腦****

This is context-sensitive because:

> “I wrote in my notebook.”

clearly means a paper book,

while:

> “The notebook has 16 GB of memory.”

clearly means a computer.

7. ****notebook paper (筆記簿用紙) — 筆記紙；活頁紙****

A useful compound.

Practice 14

> “Write your answer on **notebook paper**.”

「把答案寫在**筆記紙**上。」

Practice 15

> “He used old **notebook paper** to make the rocket.”

「他用舊**筆記簿紙張**做火箭。」

notebook paper = 用於筆記簿、通常有橫線或格線的書寫紙

8. **spiral notebook** (螺旋簿) — 螺旋筆記簿

Practice 16

> “She bought a large **spiral notebook**.”

「她買了一本大型**螺旋筆記簿**。」

Practice 17

> “The pages in the **spiral notebook** tear out easily.”

「**螺旋筆記簿**的紙頁很容易撕下來。」

spiral notebook = 用金屬 / 塑膠螺旋圈把紙頁裝訂起來的筆記簿

9. **digital notebook** (數碼筆記本 / 筆記系統) — 數碼記事工具

A modern extension.

Practice 18

> “She keeps all her class notes in a **digital notebook**.”

「她把所有課堂筆記都放在**數碼筆記本 / 電子筆記系統**裡。」

Practice 19

> “The app works like a **digital notebook**.”

「這個應用程式就像一個**數碼記事本**。」

digital notebook = 用電子方式整理文字、圖片和筆記內容的數碼工具 / 系統

This is an extension of the paper-notebook concept rather than a new bare-word meaning in most contexts.

Important distinction: **notebook vs book**

book

is the broad category:

> a bound set of pages containing text, images, etc.

notebook

specifically emphasizes:

> pages intended for the user to write or draw in.

So:

> a novel = book

but not normally:

> notebook.

Important distinction: **notebook vs notepad**

notebook

usually has:

- * many bound pages
- * more durable form
- * often used over a longer period

notepad

usually consists of:

- * sheets attached at one edge
- * pages designed to be torn off more easily

> notebook = 筆記簿

> notepad = 便條簿 / 記事簿

Important distinction: ****notebook vs diary****

****notebook****

= general-purpose writing/notes.

****diary****

can mean:

- * personal daily record
- * appointment/calendar book, especially BrE

A notebook does not inherently contain dated personal entries.

Important distinction: ****notebook vs journal****

****notebook****

is general and functional.

****journal****

often suggests:

- * regular personal reflections
- * research notes
- * formal periodical

So:

> “I wrote the phone number in my notebook.”

sounds natural.

> “I wrote the phone number in my journal.”

would imply a more specific personal record.

Important distinction: **notebook vs exercise book**

notebook

is broad.

exercise book

especially in British English:

> a school book used for written classwork or exercises.

A student's exercise book is a type of notebook, but **notebook** is more general.

Important distinction: **notebook vs sketchbook**

notebook

primarily suggests writing/notes, although it can contain drawings.

sketchbook

specifically means:

> a book mainly for drawing and sketches.

So if Leo mainly drew cities in it, **sketchbook** would be more specific.

Important distinction: **notebook vs laptop**

This is the most important polysemy distinction.

notebook — paper book

> “I wrote it in my notebook.”

= 我把它寫在筆記簿裡。

notebook — computer

> “I bought a new notebook.”

in a technology context:

= 我買了一部新的手提電腦。

laptop

is now the more broadly used everyday term for the computer.

So context is essential.

Important distinction: **notebook computer vs tablet**

notebook/laptop

typically has:

- * built-in physical keyboard
- * laptop-style operating system
- * hinged screen

tablet

usually emphasizes:

- * touchscreen
- * slate-like form
- * optional keyboard

The categories can overlap in hybrid devices, but they are not normally identical.

Important distinction: **old notebook — age vs content**

In your sentence:

> **old notebooks**

does not necessarily mean historically old or valuable.

It simply means:

> notebooks that Leo has already used / no longer needs.

That makes them available as scrap paper.

Family-extension note

Notebook is a relatively **light polysemy case**.

The two strongest learner-relevant meanings are:

* **paper notebook** = 筆記本 / 記事本

* **notebook computer** = 手提電腦 / 筆記型電腦

Within the physical-book meaning, uses such as:

* school notebook

* sketch notebook

* reporter's notebook

are mainly **contextual functions**, not genuinely separate lexical meanings.

Useful extensions include:

* **notebook paper**

* **spiral notebook**

* **digital notebook**

So this is a good example of the manual's principle: search broadly, but do **not** inflate one stable "book for notes" concept into multiple artificial meanings merely because Chinese translations vary.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
--------------	---------------------------------------

-----	-----
-------	-------

notebook — paper book	由多頁紙裝訂而成，用來寫字、做筆記、畫圖或記錄資料的小冊子
------------------------------	-------------------------------

--	--

school notebook	學生用來抄寫、做練習或記錄學習內容的筆記簿
------------------------	-----------------------

--

personal notebook	用來記錄想法、觀察、提醒或資料的記事本	
drawing notebook	用來畫圖、速寫或記錄視覺構想的簿冊	
notebook — computer	輕便、可攜式的個人電腦；筆記型 / 手提電腦	
notebook paper	用於筆記簿、通常有橫線或格線的書寫紙	
spiral notebook	以螺旋圈裝訂紙頁的筆記簿	
digital notebook	以電子方式整理和保存筆記內容的數碼工具 / 系統	

For your original sentence

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, drawing imaginary cities, or folding paper rockets out of old ****notebooks****.”

The exact meaning is:

****notebook = 用來寫字、做筆記或畫圖的紙本筆記簿****

Therefore:

> ****old notebooks****

= ****「已經用過的舊筆記簿」****

Leo is taking paper from those notebooks and reusing it to make rockets.

So this is ****not****:

> ****notebook computer****

> = 手提電腦

The context makes the physical-paper meaning unmistakable:

> ****notebook → paper pages → fold → paper rockets****

So for polysemy purposes, ****notebook is valid but modest****: the main contrast worth teaching is ****paper notebook vs notebook computer****.